

CellTrackAnalysis Instructions

Last Updated: 7/11/2025 by Clara Shin (clara.shin@wsu.edu)

This is the **second step** of chemotaxis analysis in I2Tumbles. CellTrackAnalysis.m reads in a .mat file (the output from SimpleTracking.m) and provides chemotaxis metrics such as tumbles per second for the experimental group and individual bacterium as well. From the tracked X and Y coordinates from SimpleTracking.m, linear and angular velocity of each bacterium is derived. Then, the algorithm finds the local minima of the linear velocity and local maxima of angular velocity and find the tumble points based on the calculation (Johnson et al., 2024). It is important to understand how to interpret the results and adjust the parameters while using this algorithm.

Step 1: CellTrackAnalysis Parameters

1. Open CellTrackAnalysis.m
2. Adjust parameters. The most important parameters are listed below:

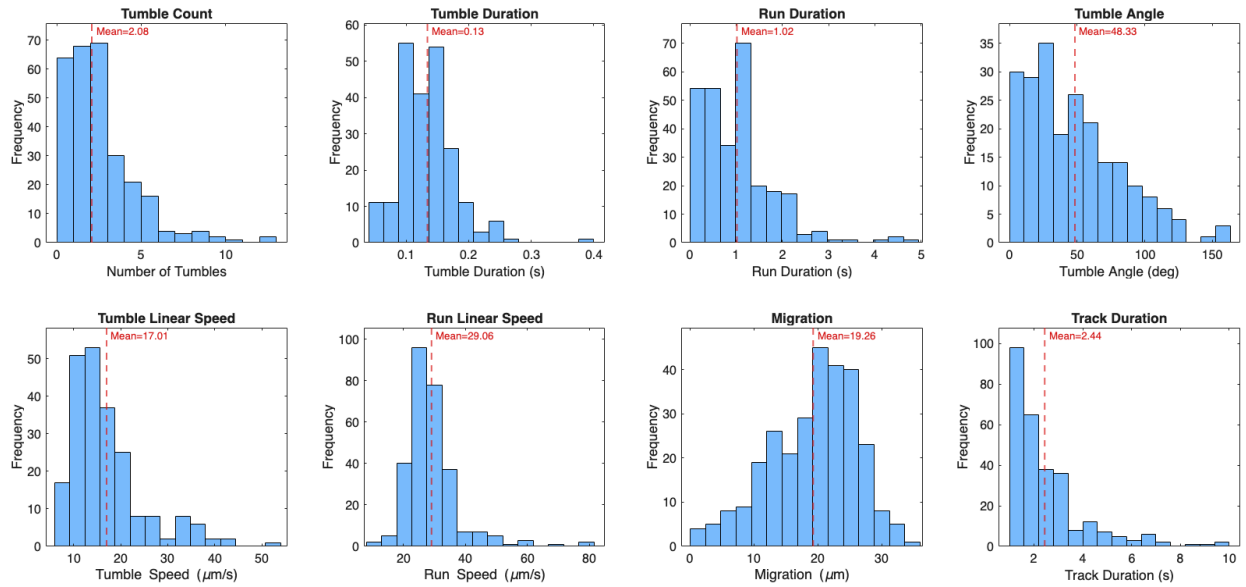
Parameter Name	Value Range	Data Type	Description
secondVideo	> 0	Integer	Duration of the video in second.
depth_speed_ratio	0.5 – 0.9999	Float	The ratio of linear speed vs local minima of the speed. The larger value will return less tumbles (more conservative). For more details, refer to Johnson et al. (2024)
show_bacteria_labels	true / false	Boolean	Setting this true will display bacteria ID numbers on the scatterplot output.
fps_scale_sg_window	true / false	Boolean	Setting this true will auto scale sg_window based on the video's FPS value. If set to false, will use the sg_window value input.
sg_window	Odd number	Integer	Window size in the Savitzky-Golay filter. A larger value will return less tumbles (more conservative). Highly recommend trying the fps_scale_sg_window = true then think about adjusting from auto-scaled number afterwards. For more details, Refer to sgolay function description in MATLAB.
convert_to_um	true / false	Boolean	Setting this to true will convert pixels to um.
px_to_um	> 0	Float	Conversion value: um per pixel
min_tumble_speed	> 0	Float	Minimum speed at tumble dip

Recommendations for adjusting the parameters:

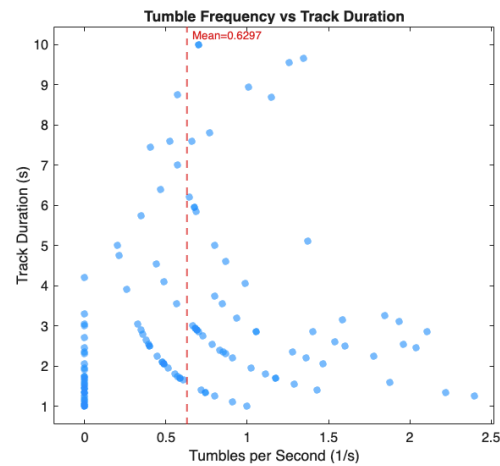
- i. Set secondVideo correctly. Metrics like tumble per second will dramatically change if this value is not correct.
- ii. Run the script with default value and run PlotTrajectory.m with bacteria_idx = 0. If the values do not make sense, adjust depth_speed_ratio.
- iii. If the algorithm is still displaying too many tumbles, try increasing sg_window with fps_scale_sg_window=false. Only odd numbers can be used for sg_window.

3. Visualizations

- a. Histogram of metrics such as tumble count, tumble and run duration, tumble angle, linear speed, migration and track duration



- b. Scatterplot of tumble frequency vs track duration



4. Outputs

- a. Printout of summary metric of the experimental group

Population Summary (N = 131 bacteria analysed)		
Metric	Mean	Median
Number of tumbles	2.11	1.00
Tumbles per second (1/s)	0.63	0.57
Tumble duration (s)	0.13	0.12
Run duration (s)	1.27	1.05
Tumble angle (deg)	44.86	38.62
Tumble linear speed ($\mu\text{m/s}$)	12.88	12.39
Run linear speed ($\mu\text{m/s}$)	22.98	22.25
Track duration (s)	3.02	2.35

b. CellTrackAnalysis_results.xlsx

i. An excel file with metrics per bacterium and summarized metrics

5. Full list of variables

Parameter Name	Value Range	Data Type	Description
secondVideo	> 0	Integer	Duration of the video in second.
convert_to_um	true / false	Boolean	Setting this to true will convert pixels to um.
px_to_um	> 0	Float	Conversion value: um per pixel
fps_scale_sg_window	true / false	Boolean	Setting this true will auto scale sg_window based on the video's FPS value. If set to false, will use the sg_window value input.
sg_window	Odd number	Integer	Window size in the Savitzky-Golay filter. A larger value will return less tumbles (more conservative). Highly recommend trying the fps_scale_sg_window = true then think about adjusting from auto-scaled number afterwards. For more details, Refer to sgolay function description in MATLAB.
sg_poly	2	Integer	Polynomial order of the function (keep at 2)
minTrackLength	sg_window + 2	Integer	Minimum track length to include in the calculation
w_offset	> 0	Integer	Rad/s offset added to the filter for overlay plot
depth_speed_ratio	0.5 – 0.9999	Float	The ratio of linear speed vs local minima of the speed. The larger value will return less tumbles (more conservative). For more details, refer to Johnson et al. (2024)
v_min_threshold	> 0	Float	Tumble frame width threshold Johnson et al. (2024)
use_angular_confirmation	true/ false	Boolean	Requires angular speed at the tumble frame to exceed the track-mean angular speed
w_confirm_factor	> 0	Float	The confirm factor number for angular speed at the tumble frame. Default value is 0.2. Johnson et al. (2024)
min_tumble_speed	> 0	Float	Minimum speed at tumble dip
show_bacteria_labels	true / false	Boolean	Setting this true will display bacteria ID numbers on the scatterplot output.
Show_plots	true/false	Boolean	Setting this true will display two visualizations (scatterplot of tumble/s, histograms of main metrics). Set this to false for faster bulk processing.

References

- Johnson et al. Run-and-tumble kinematics of *Enterobacter* Sp. SM3. *Physical Review*. E vol. 109,6–1 (2024). [\[link\]](#)
- Cell Track Analysis Algorithm GitHub: <https://github.com/Tang-BioPhys/SM3-Motility/tree/main>

